



MSI X-Slim X620 laptop

MSI launched its award winning slim laptop X-Slim X620 which boasts of an ATI Radeon HD5430 GPU with 11 hours of battery life.

MWC Mania

We take a look at the hottest phones and the latest stuff to come out of MWC

What's new at MWC?

Mobile World Congress, or MWC as its popularly known, is the world's largest exhibition for the mobile industry. This year the much awaited event was held in the Spanish city of Barcelona from February 15th — 18th. As expected the event was privy to some really hot phones and the birth of some promising operating systems. Here we shortlist three phones which we feel are worth keeping an eye on in the near future, followed by a report on the Windows Mobile 7 platform. So let's check out some of these cellular wonders first.

Samsung Wave

Samsung had previously launched their proprietary Bada OS back in November last year and at this year's MWC we finally got to see it in action



Samsung Wave

as Samsung unveiled their first Bada OS enabled smartphone called the Samsung Wave (S8500).

Samsung Wave has a 3.3 inch super AMOLED screen having a 800 x 480 pixel WVGA resolution. Normal AMOLED screens have a glass layer and an electric sensor

layer separated by air, but super AMOLED has merges these two layers. This, claims Samsung, reduces reflections by five times than a normal AMOLED screen.

The phone runs on a Cortex A8 1GHz processor which is the same that runs on iPhone 3GS and the Palm Pre albeit on lower clocks. A 5MP auto-focus camera is located on the rear side with an LED flash. Wave has features like integrated contacts — which gets all the various channels of communication like calling, messaging, Facebook, Twitter on one screen; push to calendar — which integrates Google, Yahoo and other calendars.

Samsung claims that their main idea behind developing Bada was to make the smartphones more accessible to the masses. It is partly built on a Linux kernel and the company plans to release the Software development kit (SDK) to developers in March for building applications.

Samsung Apps is the apps store from where you can download applications.

Xperia X10 Mini and X10 Mini Pro

Sony Ericsson launched their credit card sized smartphones Xperia X10 mini and Xperia X10 mini pro at the Mobile World Congress in Barcelona. The most striking aspect about these phones lies in the operating system.

For the first time Sony Ericsson have used the Android OS on their phones.

Android seems to have become the preferred OS if the number of mobile phone manufacturers adopting it is anything to go by. Sony Ericsson is the newest Android convert on the block. While the Xperia X10 mini has a touchscreen interface, the Xperia X10 mini pro has a QWERTY keypad which slides from beneath its tiny body.

The basic specs of the Xperia mini series includes a 2.55 inch TFT scratch resistant touchscreen, a 600MHz Qualcomm processor running Android OS v1.6. This sleek phone boasts of a 5 MP camera with auto focus and geotagging.

It has an interesting interface which has four contextual corner buttons which can be customized according to your needs. Sony Ericsson's Timescape is being hailed as an interesting feature which tends to integrate all your contacts in one place such that it is easier to access their call history, Facebook, Twitter, messaging etc all in one screen. But then we have seen this feature in HTC's Sense UI, so it's nothing really new.

"With the X10 mini and X10 mini pro we have pushed the boundaries of what is possible with smaller devices and are giving consumers exactly what they want; two high performance mobile phones with

a fully customisable user experience platform and a stunning ultra-compact design," said Rikko Sakaguchi, EVP and Chief Creation Officer, Sony Ericsson.

HTC Legend

Taiwanese mobile phone manufacturing giant, HTC, launched as many as three smartphones at the Mobile World Congress. According to



Xperia X10 mini pro

speculations in the tech world, HTC is rumoured to launch over 10 smartphones in the year 2010. If MWC launches are any indication to go by, it might just be true.

The HTC Legend is the successor to the hugely popular HTC Hero, although it has many differentiating features. The chin is less prominent in the HTC Legend, but the striking aspect of the phone is that its body is carved out a single aluminum block, making it the first Android based phone with a unicasings. The trackball has been replaced by an optical trackpad.

Legend boasts of a 3.2 inch AMOLED screen which promises a rich experience with its enhanced graphics and a capacitive touchscreen. It runs on Android Éclair (v2.1).

It has some other nifty